

to the ultimate high seems to help performance, but I haven't found a way to predict that kind of a volume trend.

Table 24.7, how often stops hit, is missing. My computer can't correctly place stops for this pattern, so I don't show the table.

[Table 24.8](#) shows the performance over three decades.

Performance over time. Downward breakouts show good performance back in the 1990s, but performance has steadily declined since. Upward breakouts did best in the 2000s with the other two decades performing close to one another (within two percentage points).

Failures over time. Downward breakouts show steadily increasing failure rates, where the numbers represent how often a diamond top fails to see price move more than 5% after the breakout.

Upward breakouts don't show the same trend. Rather, the 2010s have the highest failures and the 2000s showed the fewest.

[Table 24.9](#) shows busted pattern performance.

Busted patterns count. A third of diamond tops will bust. That means price moves no more than 10% after the breakout before it reverses and sails across the pattern to break out in the new direction.

Busted occurrence. Single busts happen most often, but you'll have to consult the table for whether double or more than two (triple+) busts come in second. I like to see single busted counts higher, like 70% or more. That way, if I want to trade a busted pattern, I can assume it'll single bust and give me the best performance. Because single busts are below 70%, I'd avoid trading a busted pattern unless you were sure it would single bust. Why the emphasis on single busted patterns?

Busted and non-busted performance. The answer is because single busted patterns perform best. They beat the three combinations (single, double, and triple+, combined) and non-busted patterns. In fact, patterns busting a downward breakout perform twice as well as their non-busted counterparts. Isn't that a trip?